



Bangladesh's skipper
Nigar Sultana Joty
continues to be the
team's fulcrum and will
desperately need her
colleagues to step up
with the bat.



grappling with the uncertainties of civil unrest and political change. It will open proceedings in Sharjah against debutante Scotland. Led by the Bryce sisters — skipper Katherine and vice-captain Sarah — the Scots have always been eager to punch above their weight.

The team fought for its right to be in the UAE, having made the cut through the qualifiers held in the same country a few months ago. The side is therefore ready for the conditions there, having played

under the famous ring lights in Dubai and familiarised itself with the wickets.

Scotland recently registered encouraging victories against the Netherlands and Papua New Guinea in a tri-series but last played an international in August. The month leading to the World Cup has been more focused on training and skills development.

The strongest opponent Scotland faced this year was Sri Lanka in the World Cup qualifiers, and they will

enter the event as the sprightly underdog hoping to ruffle as many feathers as possible.

Sri Lanka, meanwhile, is on the brink of transformation, like a caterpillar about to break out of its cocoon with new wings. While seasoned captain Athapaththu remains the face of the team, the focus this time will be on the youngsters she has long been pushing to the forefront.

The side is a cocktail of age groups that's managed to hit just the